Crumbs World monetization — setup brief

Prepared 2026-10-13. Your call, Lloyd: donations via Ko-fi, dev tools for sale via itch.io. Both pay out to PayPal — no credit card needed on your end to receive money.

Why these two fit you

- **Ko-fi = the tip jar.** Free page, 0% Ko-fi fee on one-time tips (verify in Settings before you share the link — new accounts sometimes start at 5% until you flip it off). Supporters pay with PayPal or card; the money lands in your connected PayPal. No marketplace — people only find it through links you share (game login screen, Facebook page).
- **itch.io = the tool shop.** Free to list, built for indie dev tools, files hosted for you. You set the price, and you choose what cut itch.io gets (default 10%, can be 0%). Two ways to get paid — use **"Collected by itch.io (Payouts)"**: itch.io handles the VAT/tax paperwork and you request payouts to PayPal whenever you want. One catch: you must finish a one-time tax interview (SSN) before your first payout.
- **The fee math that matters:** every card/PayPal transaction costs ~$0.30 + 2.9%. A $1 sale loses ~33% to fees; a $3 sale loses ~13%. Price tools at **$2 or more** (itch.io's own docs say the same).

Ko-fi page — exact steps (~15 min)

1. ko-fi.com → Sign up with your email.
2. Pick your page name and URL slug (ko-fi.com/yourname) — **slugs are first-come, first-served**, so don't sit on this.
3. Upload profile art — your shield logo or Melody's true-form art both work.
4. Paste the intro (draft below), tweak it in your voice.
5. Settings → Payments → connect your PayPal.
6. Settings → Payment → confirm one-time tips show **0%** fee before you share the link anywhere.
7. Put the link in the Crumbs World login screen and your Facebook page.

Draft intro (yours to edit):

> I'm Lloyd — I build Crumbs World, a game I'm making for players, and the dev tools that keep it running. Every bit of support goes straight back into keeping the game alive: server time, art, and the late nights. If the game gave you something, this is how you give a little back. Thank you.

itch.io — exact steps per tool (~20 min each)

1. itch.io → Register (free).
2. Dashboard → **New project**.
3. Title, short description, classification: **Tools** (for dev tools) or **Game** (if you list Crumbs World itself).
4. Pricing:
   - Dev tools for sale: set a price, **$2 minimum recommended** (fee math above).
   - Donations on the Crumbs World page: **"Pay what you want" with $0 minimum** — players can enter $0 or any amount. Also paste your Ko-fi link in the page description.
5. Upload the files + a cover image. itch.io hosts everything; you can push updates anytime.
6. Account settings → Seller settings → choose **"Collected by itch.io (Payouts)"** → complete the tax interview (SSN). You can start selling before it's validated, but money can't leave until it passes.
7. Set your revenue share (default 10% — your call, can be 0%).
8. Publish.

Decisions I need from you

1. **Ko-fi page name + slug** (e.g. ko-fi.com/crumbsworld). First-come — say the word and I'll hold nothing back, but only you can claim it.
2. **Which tools to sell, and at what price** — candidates:
   - FileWarden v1.0.0 (drive inventory + import mapper, approval-gated)
   - Spectral Hover Studio (image animator, PNG/WebM/GIF export)
   - Tampermonkey study-companion script (read-aloud + organized notes)
   - Instant Quote Estimator (one-tap repair quotes)
3. **PayPal email** to connect on Ko-fi (the one payouts land in).
4. **itch.io payout mode**: Payouts (recommended — they handle tax/VAT) vs Direct to you.
5. **Revenue share %** for itch.io (default 10%).
6. **Does Crumbs World itself get an itch.io page?** (pay-what-you-want download + Ko-fi link, or Ko-fi link only.)

Honest caveats

- Ko-fi has zero discovery — the link only earns if players see it in the game or on your pages.
- itch.io payouts: first payout gets a human review; transactions must sit 7 days before they're payout-eligible.

- Both count as self-employment income at tax time; itch.io generates the forms for you in Payouts mode.
- Skip Ko-fi Gold (paid monthly tier) unless you're moving real volume — the free tier's 0% on one-time tips is the whole point at this stage.